

bring all the necessary elements of the digital home network to market. Industry collaboration must encompass manufacturers, software and application developers, and service and content providers.

A collaboration of industry leaders can also facilitate industry marketing and promotion while encouraging development, interoperability, and support of digital home devices.

Standards-based interoperability framework:

While creating new product categories is important, industry leaders must first cooperatively develop an interoperability framework. This framework should define interoperable building blocks for devices and software infrastructure. It should cover physical media, network transports, media formats, streaming protocols, and digital rights management mechanisms. Standards for these areas are defined in many different forums, and compliance with them is an important first step. Ensuring device interoperability also requires the industry to come together to produce design guidelines so that the products of different vendors support a common baseline for the set of required standards. Since technology and standards continually change and improve, these design guidelines must also evolve over time and ensure continued interoperability as new and old technologies are mixed together in the digital home.

Compelling products:

Finally, diverse, interoperable products are necessary to provide consumers with broad, compelling experiences, and value throughout the digital home. Products in the digital home will embody one or both the two major functions discussed below. Digital Home Server (DHS) Devices provide media acquisition, recording, storage, and sourcing capabilities based on the digital home interoperability model, as well as content protection enforcement as required. DHS products will also include DHR device capabilities described below and may have intelligence, such as device and user services management, rich user interfaces, and media management, aggregation and distribution functions. Some examples of these devices include:

- Advanced Set-Top Boxes (STB)